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flower. When in perfection, it is very light and thin; pale, and almost colorules ; of great fragrance, the not quite for a belemary idelf. It is recomended, in the dole of a few drops, in nervous and hyfleric complaints. Borchave holds it ing great efeem againit epilepties, and fuppreffions of the use- trie purgurations, occaulted by weakens and indelh- vity.

Preparations.

535: Efential oil of ruse-laaves. L. L.

The oil of rue has a very acid tafes, and a gene- trating (well, refreshing the one of the herb, but rather more unpleasant. It is fometimes made uie of in hy- fferic diforders, and as an anthelmintic ; as alfo in epilepfics proceeding from a relaxed flate of the nerves.

Rue yields its oil very faringly. The larger quantity is obtained from which the flowers are ready to fall off, and the feeds begin to flow them!veres : fuitable maceration, previous to the distillation, is here extremely mesclitary.

536: Efential oil of fuerin leaves L. E.

This oil is a celebrated uterine and emmenagogue ; in cold plegnatic habits, it is undoubtedly a medi-cine of good fender, though not capable of performing what it has been usually represented to do. The dole is, two or three drops or more.

537: Efential oil of fulnfras L. E.

This is the most pondense of all the known effen-tial oils, but ribs in distillation with efficient cafe: it appears limpid as water, has a moderately pungent taste, a very fragment (well), exactly remember that of the inflates. If hands greatly commended a a flourir, and for purifying the blood and joves: it is like- wife topped to be of review in humoural ashmas and coughs. The dole is from one chop to eight or ten , though Geoffroy goes as far as so.

The decoction remaining after the distillation of the oil, afford, by infiltration, an useful extract of a mold, bitterth, albalkringed tafte. Hufman fays, he has given it with great benefits, in doses of a teruple, as a corroborant in cachethe cafes, in the decline of interming fevers, and for abating hypochondriacal fpafms.

538: Oil of turpentine L. E.

This is distilled in the time manner as the forego- ing oils, and is finally an official one, though not ufually ranked in this clafa: it is commonly, but im- properly, called _fprins of turpentine_. It is employed in large quantities for tone mechanic purpoda and hence the distillation of it is become a particular bufi-neis.

This oil is a sexy hot, stimulating medicine. It is fometines given as a fudorlic and diuretic, in the dole of two or three drops in larger doses, it is apt to greetly heat the body, coactalion pain of the head, an effusion of the fenect and liquor of the parasite glands. It has nevertheless been of late taken in considerable dofer (along with honey or other convict wolhic) against the delicate ; and, as is field, with good facects. Some have recommended it against vertical ruminants - but here I is has produced mir- chievous consequences, influming the parts and ag-gravating the diforder. Externally it is not unfre

nestly employed against rheumatic pains, aches, fprains, for dicuffing cold tumours, and restraining hemors- rhages.

539. After the distillation of the turpentine, there re- manus in the fill a brittle refinous folblance, of a yellow colour, called _yellow refin [L.]_.

The only uie of this is in external applications, for giving confidence to platters, and the like purposes.

_540. Most of the foregoing oils are drawn by our chemits, and easily procurable in a tolerable degree of perfections i thofe of cinnamon, cloves, numanges, and maces, accepted. There are usually imported from abroad ; and are for the molt part fo much adulterated, that it is difficult to meet with fuch as are at all fit for life.

Nor are the adulterations of thefe kinds of prepara-tions easily disconoable. The groffer abubic indeed may be readily detected, thus if the oil is mixed with fpirit of wine, it will turn milky on the addition of water ; if with spearful oils, rectificil spirit will differ the eficient, and leave the ober behind; if with oil of turpentine, no dipping a piece of paper in the mixture, and drying it with a gentle heat, the turpen- we will be betrayed by its final). But the more fubble artifilt have corrected other methods ofophilisation, which elude all trials of this kind.

Some have looked upon the specific gravity of oils, as a certain criterion of their genunements. This, however, is not to be ablotely depended on ; for the genuine oils, obtained from the fabelj, often- times differ in gravity as much as those draws from different ones. Cinnamon and cloves, whole oils ufually link to water, yield, if flowly and vastly di- filled, as oil of great fragency, which is nevertheless specifically lighter than the aqueous fluid employed in the distillation of it; whillts, on the other hand, the full rumants of some of the lightest oils prove feme-times to poucious as to funk in water.

As all efential oils agree in the general properties of fishability to prints of wine, individuality in waters, mifcibility with water by the intervention of certain intermedies, volatility in the least of boiling water, &c. is la plain that they may be variously mixed with one another, or the denser highlifted with the cheapys, without any polifficiency of discovering the abuse by any trials of this kind. And indeed, it would not be of much advantages to the purchase if he had infiable criteria of the genunements of every individual oil. It is of as much importance, then they may be _goods_, as that they may be _genuers_; for we have often seen genuine oils, from incautious dililitations, and long and careful keeping, weaker both in fuell and tafte than the common sophisticated ones.

The fuell and tafte form to be the only certain tells that the nature of the thing will admit of. If a bark flould have in every refined the appearance of good cinnamon, and flould be proved indispensable to be the genuine bark of the cinnamon trees yet, if it wants the cinnamon flavors, or has it but in low deer, we yriclet it and the safe is the time with the oil. It is only from uie and habit, or comparison with fpecinens of known quality, that we can judge of the goodhefs, either of the droge themfrelves, or of their oils.

Source record

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Preparations.

flower. When in perfection, it is very light and thin; pale, and almoſt colourleſs; of great fragrancy, tho' not quite ſo agreeable as the roſemary itſelf. It is recommended, in the doſe of a few drops, in nervous and hyſteric complaints. Boerhaave holds it in great eſteem againſt epilepſies, and ſuppreſſions of the uterine purgations, occaſioned by weakneſs and inactivity.

535. *Eſſential oil of rue-leaves.* L.

The oil of rue has a very acrid taſte, and a penetrating ſmell, reſembling that of the herb, but rather more unpleaſant. It is ſometimes made uſe of in hyſteric diſorders, and as an anthelmintic; as alſo in epilepſies proceeding from a relaxed ſtate of the nerves.

Rue yields its oil very ſparingly. The largeſt quantity is obtained from it when the flowers are ready to fall off, and the ſeeds begin to ſhow themſelves: ſuitable maceration, previous to the diſtillation, is here extremely neceſſary.

536. *Eſſential oil of ſavin leaves.* L. E.

This oil is a celebrated uterine and emmenagogue; in cold phlegmatic habits, it is undoubtedly a medicine of good ſervice, though not capable of performing what it has been uſually repreſented to do. The doſe is, two or three drops or more.

537. *Eſſential oil of ſaſſafras.* L. E.

This is the moſt ponderous of all the known eſſential oils, but riſes in diſtillation with ſufficient eaſe: it appears limpid as water, has a moderately pungent taſte, a very fragrant ſmell, exactly reſembling that of the ſaſſafras. It ſtands greatly commended as a ſudorific, and for purifying the blood and juices: it is likewiſe ſuppoſed to be of ſervice in humoural aſthmas and coughs. The doſe is from one drop to eight or ten; though Geoffroy goes as far as 20.

The decoction remaining after the diſtillation of the oil, affords, by inſpiſſation, an uſeful extract, of a mild, bitteriſh, ſubaſtringent taſte. Hoffman ſays, he has given it with great benefit, in doſes of a ſcruple, as a corroborant in cachectic caſes, in the decline of intermitting fevers, and for abating hypochondriacal ſpaſms.

538. *Oil of turpentine.* L. E.

This is diſtilled in the ſame manner as the foregoing oils, and is ſtrictly an eſſential one, though not uſually ranked in this claſs: it is commonly, but improperly, called *ſpirit of turpentine.* It is employed in large quantities for ſome mechanic purpoſes, and hence the diſtillation of it is become a particular buſineſs.

This oil is a very hot, ſtimulating medicine. It is ſometimes given as a ſudorific and diuretic, in the doſe of two or three drops: in larger doſes, it is apt to greatly heat the body, occaſion pain of the head, an effuſion of the ſemen and liquor of the proſtate glands. It has nevertheleſs been of late taken in conſiderable doſes (along with honey or other convenient vehicles) againſt the ſciatica; and, as is ſaid, with good ſucceſs. Some have recommended it againſt venereal runnings: but here it has produced miſchievous conſequences, inflaming the parts and aggravating the diſorder. Externally it is not unfrequently employed againſt rheumatic pains, aches, ſprains, for diſcuſſing cold tumours, and reſtraining hæmorrhages. Preparations.

539. After the diſtillation of the turpentine, there remains in the ſtill a brittle reſinous ſubſtance, of a yellow colour, called *yellow reſin* [L.]

The only uſe of this is in external applications, for giving conſiſtence to plaſters, and the like purpoſes.

540. Moſt of the foregoing oils are drawn by our chemiſts, and eaſily procurable in a tolerable degree of perfection; thoſe of cinnamon, cloves, nutmegs, and mace, excepted. Theſe are uſually imported from abroad; and are for the moſt part ſo much adulterated, that it is difficult to meet with ſuch as are at all fit for uſe.

Nor are the adulterations of theſe kinds of preparations eaſily diſcoverable. The groſſer abuſes indeed may be readily detected: thus if the oil is mixed with ſpirit of wine, it will turn milky on the addition of water; if with expreſſed oils, rectified ſpirit will diſſolve the eſſential, and leave the other behind; if with oil of turpentine, on dipping a piece of paper in the mixture, and drying it with a gentle heat, the turpentine will be betrayed by its ſmell. But the more ſubtle artiſts have contrived other methods of ſophiſtication, which elude all trials of this kind.

Some have looked upon the ſpecific gravity of oils, as a certain criterion of their genuineneſs. This, however, is not to be abſolutely depended on; for the genuine oils, obtained from the ſame ſubject, oftentimes differ in gravity as much as thoſe drawn from different ones. Cinnamon and cloves, whoſe oils uſually ſink in water, yield, if ſlowly and warily diſtilled, an oil of great fragrancy, which is nevertheleſs ſpecifically lighter than the aqueous fluid employed in the diſtillation of it; whilſt, on the other hand, the laſt runnings of ſome of the lighter oils prove ſometimes ſo ponderous as to ſink in water.

As all eſſential oils agree in the general properties of ſolubility in ſpirit of wine, indiſſolubility in water, miſcibility with water by the intervention of certain intermedia, volatility in the heat of boiling water, &c. it is plain that they may be variouſly mixed with one another, or the dearer ſophiſticated with the cheaper, without any poſſibility of diſcovering the abuſe by any trials of this kind. And indeed, it would not be of much advantage to the purchaſer if he had infallible criteria of the genuineneſs of every individual oil. It is of as much importance, that they may be *good*, as that they may be *genuine*; for we have often ſeen genuine oils, from incautious diſtillation, and long and careleſs keeping, weaker both in ſmell and taſte than the common ſophiſticated ones.

The ſmell and taſte ſeem to be the only certain teſts that the nature of the thing will admit of. If a bark ſhould have in every reſpect the appearance of good cinnamon, and ſhould be proved indiſputably to be the genuine bark of the cinnamon tree; yet, if it wants the cinnamon flavour, or has it but in a low degree, we reject it: and the caſe is the ſame with the oil. It is only from uſe and habit, or compariſon with ſpecimens of known quality, that we can judge of the goodneſs, either of the drugs themſelves, or of their oils.

Moſt

Figure 1: *
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